



CAPITAL HORROR

A VOLUNTEER cleans the Yamuna in Delhi as part of a drive to scoop up filth, plastic and other waste from the river's banks. About 3.6 billion tonnes of untreated sewerage flows daily into the Yamuna, which supplies over 60 per cent of Delhi's water.

BHASKAR PAUL/www.indiatodayimages.com



KANU SANYAL, ONE OF THE FOUNDERS OF THE NAXALITE MOVEMENT, LIVED THE LAST FEW YEARS OF HIS LIFE DISTANCED FROM THE MAOIST CAUSE.

KOLKATA | Opting Out

With West Bengal reeling under the Maoist insurgency, the man who was an inspiration to all forms of "revolution" by "violent means" sought to end it all. Kanu Sanyal, the veteran CPI(M) leader who started the infamous Naxalbari movement in 1969, committed suicide by hanging himself at his residence at Naxalbari in West Bengal. He was 78, a bachelor and suffering from age-related illnesses. But he was best remembered as one of the chief players of the Naxalite movement that rocked the state in the 1970s. The movement was driven by radical communist ideology to initiate an "Indian revolution" by violent means. Later disillusioned with the Maoist movement, which targeted even poor farmers, Sanyal began to distance himself from what he called the "excesses" of violence. Till his death he believed that the "dream of establishing a people's democracy in its true sense still remains". In 2006, Sanyal took part in the Singur agitation over land acquisition and in tea garden protests in north Bengal.

by Elora Sen